

Digital Positive Interventions: Using Mindful Tea-Drinking Practice to Promote the Chinese Workplace Flourishing

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Master of Applied Positive Psychology, 2023

Introduction

Current Situations in the Chinese Workplace

- "996. ICU" movement in China: working from 9:00 am to 9:00 pm, six days a week, could lead to serious physical and psychological issues, potentially landing them in the intensive care unit (ICU) (GitHub, 2019).
- The pandemic exacerbated workplace challenges. One study shows that 44.6% of the professionals reported anxiety, 50.4% depression, 71.5% distress, and 34.0% insomnia (Lai et al., 2020).

Positive Psychology Interventions (PPIs)

- Intentional activities that improve positive emotions, behaviors, and cognitions (Sin & Lyubomirsky, 2009).

Digital Positive Interventions (DPIs)

- Self-guided, interactive, and customized interventions that integrate PPIs with technologies (Proudfoot et al., 2011; Ritterband et al., 2003).

Literature Review



Chinese Tea Culture and Zen

The spirit of Zen and tea drinking is the same (Wilson, 2013).



Mindfulness

Intentionally focusing on the present moment without judgment (Kabat-Zinn, 2009).



Savoring

The ability to attend to, enjoy and improve the positive experiences in one's life (Bryant & Veroff, 2017).



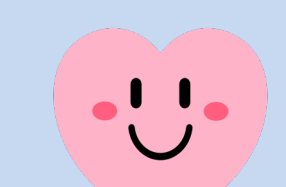
Mind-Body Connection

The mind and body are interconnected intimately (Kabat-Zinn, 2009).



Engagement

Being one with the activity and feeling the loss of self-consciousness and time stopping (Seligman, 2011).



Positive Emotions

Those emotions bring pleasant subjective experiences: joy, serenity, gratitude, and love (Fredrickson, 2013).



Positive Relationships

Other people matter (Peterson, 2006).



Optimism

Optimists believe that bad events are temporary and caused by specific external factors (Seligman, 2006).

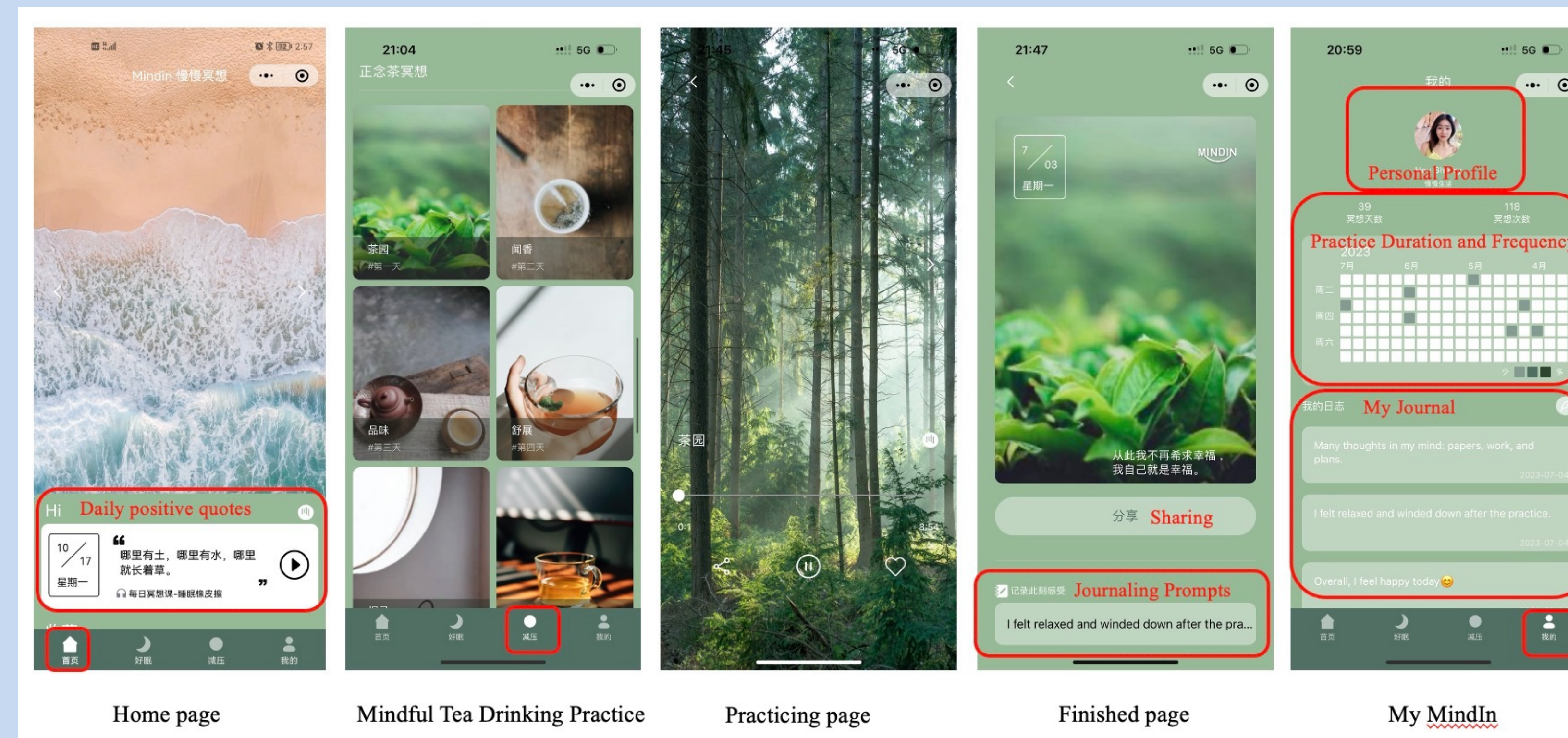
Mindful Tea-Drinking Practice as a Digital Positive Intervention

Overview of The Mindful Tea-Drinking Practice (MTDP)

Schedule	Titles	Theories	Techniques
Day 1	Breathing with Tea	Mindfulness	Mindful Breathing
Day 2	Savoring the Tea	Savoring	Mindful Drinking
Day 3	Mind-Body Connection	Mind-body Connection	Body Scan
Day 4	Being Present	Engagement	Stop Breathe Be
Day 5	Positive Emotions	Positive Emotions (joy, serenity, gratitude, love)	Positive Emotions
Day 6	Positive Relationships	Positive Relationships	Loving Kindness
Day 7	Cultivating Optimism	Optimism	ABCDE Model

The Mindfulness App: MindIn

- Positive interactions
- Habituations
- Personalization



The Mindful Tea: Tea 4 Mind



The Intervention

Hypothesis

- Mindful tea-drinking practice as a form of DPI can promote the Chinese workplace flourishing.

Participants:

- 120 employees from a Chinese IT company in Shanghai, with ages ranging from 22 to 45, are randomly assigned to 3 groups.

Procedure

- Intervention group: attending 4-week MTDP.
- Control group: 4-week tea drinking.
- Baseline group: blank control group.

Measures

- Workplace PERMA Profiler (Kern, 2014).
- ANOVA.

Discussion

Advantages

- Cultural alignment and person-activity fit.
- Enhancing workplace flourishing by using PPI approaches.
- Accessibility, flexibility, and personalization.
- Using positive interactions and habituation to enhance engagement, motivation, and commitment.
- High scalability, cost-effectiveness, and potential popularity.

Limitations

- Small effect sizes and low adherence compared with in-person interventions.

Future Directions

- Using Artificial Intelligence (AI) to enhance the effectiveness and engagement of DPIs.
- Integrating AI, specifically Chat GPT, into DPIs to build an AI psychological coach.
- Training the AI chatbot with a variety of PPIs to help individuals improve their positive emotions and relationships in the real world, become better versions of themselves, and ultimately live flourishing lives.